This was going to develop into "dianetics," out of which Hubbard was to make his fortune and gain his godhead. Campbell was unabashedly enthusiastic about it, and this marked his first dip into the kind of mysticism that was to consume him for the rest of his life. As I listened to Campbell describe what was to become dianetics, I sat there, cold and untouched.

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Once the summer heat was over, the Somerville apartment became quite bearable. We had an active social life not only with the New York people who had come to Boston for jobs, but also with some of the people we had met at Birchtoft. Then too, I attended seminars with ambition and energy, not only at the Medical School, but also at Harvard and MIT. I was doing my best to get the feeling of being part of the academic life, and I was trying to take it for granted that my salary would be continued for year after year.

Boston University Medical School was an old institution. Its three

buildings were ancient and the laboratories were less impressive than those of Columbia, let alone the Navy Yard. Its drabness seemed suitable for the South End, a very rundown section of Boston.

The main campus of Boston University, on Commonwealth Avenue in the Back Bay, was much more modern and impressive, but the Medical School's location, poor as it was in a material sense, was between Boston City Hospital and Massachusetts Memorial Hospital, and that was good for clinical training.

As for myself, since I was not visual, I got used to the drabness quickly and got to work on my research project, in which I intended to deal with the structure of nucleic acids. Among other things, I set about trying to make use of paper chromatography as a tool. This was a way of separating the components of a complex mixture by having them travel at different speeds along porous paper. In this way I hoped to determine the percentage of different bases in nucleic acids taken from normal and cancerous tissue and, perhaps, get an inkling of the basic chemical change that brought on cancer.

In hindsight, I am quite convinced that this line of attack would not have given me any useful information on the cancer problem, but I might have come up with something interesting in other directions if the course of events had allowed me to continue my research long enough. Who knows?

In October, meanwhile, I tackled "The Evitable Conflict" in earnest and finished it in four weeks. I mailed it to Campbell on October 31, and on